REBUTTAL TO ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE B

The argument against Measure B has it backwards.

Gilroy does prioritize police and fire response, street repair, emergency preparedness, parks, and other essential City services. Every year, the City Council makes tough budget choices about what Gilroy can afford — with residents' input through the City's public budget process. Measure B strengthens the budget, adding dedicated revenue so residents no longer shoulder the full cost alone.

Today, those services are primarily paid for by Gilroy residents and local businesses. Yet visitors who stay overnight in Gilroy also use our streets, rely on public safety and emergency response, and benefit from City services—without contributing to their full cost.

Measure B is about fairness. It allows visitors staying in hotels and other lodging to contribute toward the local services and infrastructure they use.

The increase is modest: two percentage points, from 9% to 11%, with a strict, voter-approved ceiling of 13%. It does not raise property, sales, or utility taxes on residents. The additional funds remain in Gilroy, cannot be taken by Sacramento, and are subject to annual independent audits.

Gilroy's hotel tax hasn't changed since 1983 and remains lower than many neighboring cities, where visitors already pay comparable rates without hesitation. This won't drive visitors away — it simply asks them to pay their fair share, the same way Gilroy residents already do.

This argument is signed by an outside, countywide advocacy group — not local officials accountable to Gilroy voters.

Fund critical services fairly. Vote YES on Measure B.

Greg Bozzo

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Mayor, City of Gilroy